A-A-53580
29 July 1988

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

HOLDER, SURGICAL INSTRUMENT STERILIZATION

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description.

This Commercial Item Description covers an instrument suitable for holding ringed forceps during the sterilization process.

Salient characteristics:

The holder shall be an instrument of the Weinstein design, approximately 12 inches by 2-3/4 inches (30.48 cm by 6.98 cm), suitable for use in holding ringed forceps in the open position for maximum steam penetration during the sterilization process. It shall be able to hold from 24 to 36 ringed forceps.

The holder shall be fabricated of a suitable corrosion-resisting steel, American Iron and Steel Institute (AISI) Series 300, properly tempered and passivated. The holder must withstand continued use at sterilization temperatures above 270°F without failure.

The holder shall consist of two parts, a hollow short horseshoe-shaped bar which will fit over a second part, a long solid horseshoe-shaped bar. The two horseshoe-shaped bars shall be fastened together with a slip spring closure to form an oblong-shaped instrument holder. The holder shall be smooth, without defects, to insure against tearing of gloves during surgery.

The diameter of the bars shall be large enough to allow the holder to support a maximum number of ringed instruments without bending.

The holder shall be supplied free of oil, grease, dirt, or other contamination. The holder shall be easy to clean after use.

AMSC N/A FSC 6530

DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A. Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited.

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Workmanship. The surgical instrument sterilization holder shall be free from defects which detract from its appearance or impair its serviceability.

Unit. Each (EA). One surgical instrument sterilization holder, as specified, constitutes one unit.

Quality Assurance Provisions.

Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

Inspection. Inspection, as used herein, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements. Where feasible, the same sample shall be used for the determination of two or more test characteristics.

Sampling for examination. Sampling for examination shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105, with an AQL of 1.0 (percent defective) and an inspection level of II. The unit of product for examination purposes shall be one surgical instrument sterilization holder as specified in this description.

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Defects.

Holder has component parts missing or broken.

Holder not fabricated of a suitable corrosion-resisting steel, American Iron and Steel Institute (AISI) Series 300.

Slip spring closure does not hold horseshoe-shaped bars together securely.

Holder does not hold a minimum of 24 ringed forceps without bending.

Holder does not have smooth finish without defects.

Holder is not supplied free of oil, grease, dirt, or other contamination.

Holder is not easy to clean after use.

Sampling for tests. Sampling for tests, including dimensional test, shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105, with an AQL of 2.5 (percent defective) and an inspection level of S-1. The unit of product for test purposes shall be one surgical instrument sterilization holder.

Tests.

Boil Test. The holder sample shall be subjected to the boil methods of ASTM F 1089, Standard Test Method for Corrosion of Surgical Instruments. At completion of the test, any surface showing signs of corrosion (without magnification) shall constitute a defect.

Autoclave Test. The holder sample shall be subjected to an autoclave temperature of 270°F for a period of 15 minutes for a total of ten cycles. The holder shall be cooled to room temperature between cycles.

The sample shall be visually inspected at the end of the ten cycles. Any surface showing signs of corrosion (without magnification) shall constitute a defect.

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Metric products. Products manufactured to metric dimensions will be considered on an equal basis with those manufactured using inch-pound units, providing they fall within the tolerances specified using conversion tables contained in the latest revision of Federal Standard 376, and all other requirements of this document are met.

If a product is manufactured to metric dimensions and those dimensions exceed the tolerances specified in the inch/pound units, a request should be made to the contracting officer to determine if the product is acceptable.

The contracting officer has the option of accepting or rejecting the product.

Contractor certification. The contractor shall certify that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this description and conforms to the producers' own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

Regulatory requirements.

Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act. If the product covered by this document has been determined by the U.S. Food and Drug Administration to be under its jurisdiction, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act, as amended, and regulations promulgated thereunder. In addition, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of all other applicable Federal, State, and local statutes, ordinances, and regulations.

Recovered materials. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered material in accordance with Public Law 94-580, as amended, and as implemented by Federal Acquisition Regulation Subpart 23.4 to the maximum extent practical.

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Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. Unless otherwise specified, preservation, packaging, and packing shall be to a degree of protection to preclude damage to containers and/or contents thereof under normal shipping conditions, handling, etc., involving shipment from the supply source to the receiving activity, plus reshipment from receiving activity, and shall conform to applicable carrier's rules and regulations. Intermediate and exterior package quantities and labeling and marking shall be as specified in the contract and/or order.

NOTE: The following National Stock Number is covered by this document:

6530-01-139-8074

Ordering data. Intermediate/exterior package quantities, labeling, and marking must be specified in the contract and/or order.

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians:

Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

DoD - MB

Agent:

DLA-DM

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

VA-OSS
PHS
FDA-MPQAS

Project No. 6530-2005

PGC 52497

Location:
CID/HOLDER/SURG/INS/H13-32

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1 DOCUMENT NUMBER	2 DOCUMENT TITLE
A-A-53580	HOLDER, SURGICAL INSTRUMENT STERILIZATION

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4 TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR
	☐ USER
b ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	☐ MANUFACTURER
	☐ OTHER *(Specify)*

5 PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording

b. Recommended Wording

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation

6 REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

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